

hour to ensure that people did not require to visit DTOs at all. The objective was to fulfil the motto of "Minimum Government and maximum Governance", bring in transparency and efficiency in office procedures and save precious man-days. All these requirements culminated in the development of contactless transport services in Assam with the use of technology and automation. All the people opting for any transport-related services such as issue of driving license, registration of vehicles and route permit became the main beneficiaries of these services.

Thus, in its endeavour for excellence in the delivery of citizen-centric public services through automation and use of technology in a contactless/faceless manner, the transport department, since September 3, 2021, has launched 45 services, which is the highest number of such services by any state in India. Here are the salient features of these services:

1. No need to visit DTO offices
2. Doorstep service in a hassle-free way
3. Online application from anywhere
4. Online cashless fee payment
5. Saves precious productive man-days
6. Eliminates scope of entry of any middleman, thereby bringing transparency

Use of technology helped in developing several contactless services, processes and even auto-approval in certain services such as issuing learners license and no objection certificate (NOC). Contactless services in online mode with online payment options, scrutiny, and online approval till the delivery of final output (driving licence and registration certificate in case of transport services) by post to the registered address of the applicant or the facility of downloading directly from anywhere (in case of learners license and NOC) do away with the requirement of visiting any office. It's a seamless, faceless, end-to-end service delivery mechanism, which is more responsive, transparent, and efficient.

The Aadhaar based authentication is another notable feature of some of the contactless services. The 10 Aadhar-based contactless services include six Vahan software-based services—transfer of ownership-related (of



"In pursuance of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision, all efforts are being made to minimise compliance burden for common people in obtaining government services. The online transport services are a step in that direction."

Dr Himanta Biswa Sarma
Chief Minister, Assam

A NOVEL MOVE

The CM – Transport Randomised Allocation Networked System (CM-Trans) is the most unique digital initiative of Assam government. This pioneering initiative ushers in a mechanism which not only provides online application and disposal facilities to citizens but also uniformly distributes workload among all district transport offices (DTO) to increase the speed and efficiency of service deliverance. A brainchild of Chief Minister Dr Himanta Biswa Sarma, it's the first such system launched in any state of India. The new system, launched on May 13, 2022, does away with the concept of verification and approval of applications in the same DTO where it has been submitted. Instead, it randomly allocates an application to any of the 32 DTOs of Assam based on their individual workload. The application is automatically routed to the DTOs where the pendency is comparatively less. The applicant and the DTO, in which he or she submitted the application, do not get to know which DTO has been allocated the responsibility of processing the application. This ensures complete elimination of the role of the middle men and unnecessary harassment of applicants.